

NovaTech Solutions — Product User Manual

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Table of Contents

1. Introduction
 2. Installation and Access
 3. Initial Setup and Onboarding
 4. Dashboard Overview
 5. Core Feature Walkthroughs by Product
 6. User Roles and Permissions
 7. Notifications
 8. Reports
 9. Settings
 10. Collaboration Tools
 11. Intelligent Features and Automation
 12. Exporting Data
 13. Administration
 14. Best Practices
 15. Summary
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1. Introduction

This manual provides end-to-end guidance for setting up and using the NovaTech Solutions product suite: NovaTech CRM, NovaTech Projects, NovaTech Connect, NovaTech Insights, and NovaTech Helpdesk. It is intended for new users completing initial onboarding as well as administrators configuring the platform for their organization. Screens and menu paths referenced throughout reflect the current release as of the Last Updated date above; minor interface changes may occur between quarterly releases, with details published in the release notes at novatechsolutions.com/releases.

2. Installation and Access

NovaTech products are primarily delivered through a web browser and require no local installation for core functionality. Supported browsers and minimum system requirements are detailed in the Product Catalog (Document 1), Section 9.

For users who prefer a native application experience:

- **NovaTech Connect** offers downloadable desktop applications for Windows, macOS, and Linux, available at novatechsolutions.com/download.
- **Mobile applications** for all five products are available on the Apple App Store (iOS 16+) and Google Play Store (Android 11+).

To install the Connect desktop application:

1. Navigate to novatechsolutions.com/download and select the appropriate operating system.
2. Run the downloaded installer and follow the on-screen prompts.
3. Launch the application and sign in using your organization credentials or SSO provider.
4. Confirm notification and microphone/camera permissions when prompted, to enable meeting functionality.

Note: Desktop application installation does not require administrator privileges on most standard corporate device configurations, but IT-managed devices with restricted installation policies may require deployment through a mobile device management (MDM) system. Enterprise customers can request a pre-packaged MSI/PKG installer for MDM deployment from their Customer Success Manager.

3. Initial Setup and Onboarding

After an account is created, the account owner is guided through a setup wizard covering organization details, initial user invitations, and product-specific configuration defaults. The wizard can be exited and resumed at any time from Admin Console > Setup Progress.

3.1 Organization Setup Checklist

- Confirm organization name, industry, and time zone
- Configure a custom domain (optional, Professional and Enterprise)
- Set the default currency and fiscal year start month
- Invite initial users and assign product access
- Configure Single Sign-On, if applicable (Professional and Enterprise)
- Import existing data (contacts, projects, tickets) using the guided import tool

3.2 Data Migration

Customers migrating from another platform can use the Guided Import Tool, accessible from Data Management > Import, which supports CSV and Excel file formats along with pre-built mapping templates for several common competing platforms. For migrations exceeding 50,000 records or involving complex custom object structures, NovaTech recommends purchasing a Premium Onboarding Package, which includes dedicated migration assistance from the Implementation team.

Tip: Run a test import of a small sample (50-100 records) before importing a full dataset, to confirm field mapping is correct and avoid the need for bulk corrections afterward.

4. Dashboard Overview

Each product opens to a default home dashboard summarizing the most relevant information for the logged-in user's role.

Product	Default Dashboard Contents
CRM	Open deals by stage, tasks due today, recent activity feed
Projects	Active projects assigned to the user, upcoming deadlines, workload summary
Connect	Recent channels, unread messages, upcoming meetings
Insights	Prebuilt dashboards relevant to the user's department, recently viewed reports
Helpdesk	Assigned open tickets, SLA countdown indicators, team queue overview

Dashboards are customizable for individual users through the "Edit Layout" option, which allows widgets to be added, removed, resized, and rearranged. Administrators can also configure organization-wide default dashboards that apply to new users upon first login, which individual users can still further personalize unless the administrator has locked the layout.

5. Core Feature Walkthroughs by Product

5.1 NovaTech CRM

Creating a Deal:

1. Navigate to Pipeline and select "New Deal."
2. Enter deal name, associated account/contact, value, and expected close date.
3. Select the appropriate pipeline stage.
4. Save the record; the deal now appears on the pipeline board.

Setting Up an Automation:

1. Navigate to Settings > Automations > New Automation.
2. Define the trigger condition (e.g., "Deal Stage changes to Negotiation").
3. Define the resulting action (e.g., "Create Task" or "Send Email").
4. Activate the automation; it will apply going forward, not retroactively.

5.2 NovaTech Projects

Creating a Project from a Template:

1. Navigate to Projects > New Project > From Template.
2. Select a template category (e.g., Software Release, Marketing Campaign).
3. Adjust default task list, assignees, and due dates as needed.
4. Confirm creation; the project appears in List, Board, Gantt, and Calendar views simultaneously.

Running a Sprint:

1. Add backlog items to the sprint from the Backlog view.
2. Set sprint start and end dates.
3. Begin the sprint; a burndown chart automatically generates and updates as tasks are completed.

5.3 NovaTech Connect

Starting a Video Meeting:

1. From any channel or direct message, select the video camera icon.
2. Choose "Start Now" or "Schedule for Later."
3. Share the generated meeting link with internal or external participants as needed.

5.4 NovaTech Insights

Building a Custom Dashboard:

1. Navigate to Dashboards > New Dashboard.
2. Select a data source (single product or blended cross-product).
3. Drag and drop widgets (charts, tables, scorecards) onto the canvas.
4. Configure filters and save; the dashboard can be shared with specific users or the full organization.

5.5 NovaTech Helpdesk

Responding to a Ticket:

1. Open the ticket from the shared queue or personal assignment list.
 2. Review the customer's message and any prior internal notes.
 3. Use a canned response template or compose a reply directly.
 4. Update ticket status (e.g., Open, Pending, Resolved) before submitting the reply.
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6. User Roles and Permissions

NovaTech products use a role-based permission model. Standard roles available across products include:

Role	Typical Access Level
Administrator	Full configuration and data access across the product
Manager	Full data access within assigned team/territory; limited configuration access
Contributor	Create and edit records within assigned scope
Viewer	Read-only access to assigned records and dashboards

Custom roles can be created on Professional and Enterprise editions from Admin Console > Roles > New Role, allowing granular control over which objects, fields, and actions a role can access. Role assignment is managed per user under Admin Console > Users, and a single user may hold different roles across different NovaTech products (for example, Administrator in Projects but Contributor in CRM).

Warning: Removing Administrator access from the only remaining administrator on an account is blocked by the system; at least one active administrator must always be designated.

7. Notifications

Notifications can be delivered via in-app alert, email, and (for Connect and Helpdesk) push notification on mobile devices. Users manage their personal notification preferences under Settings > Notifications, where they can control frequency and channel per notification type, such as:

- Task or ticket assignment
- @Mentions in comments or messages
- Approaching due dates and SLA breach warnings
- Deal stage changes
- Scheduled report delivery

Administrators can configure organization-wide default notification settings, and can enforce certain critical notifications (such as SLA breach warnings for managers) as non-optional on Enterprise editions.

Tip: Users experiencing notification fatigue can switch from real-time delivery to a Daily Digest option under Notification Settings, which consolidates non-urgent alerts into a single daily summary email.

8. Reports

Each product includes both prebuilt standard reports and a custom report builder (Professional and Enterprise editions; Starter editions are limited to prebuilt templates).

Building a Custom Report:

1. Navigate to Reports > New Report.
2. Select the primary data object (e.g., Deals, Tasks, Tickets).
3. Choose report type: Tabular, Summary, or Matrix.
4. Add filters, grouping, and summary fields as needed.
5. Save and optionally schedule the report for recurring delivery.

Scheduled reports can be delivered by email on a daily, weekly, or monthly cadence, or posted automatically to a NovaTech Connect channel. Report access can be restricted to specific users or roles, independent of the underlying data's own sharing rules, allowing summary-level reporting to be shared more broadly than the underlying detailed records.

9. Settings

Settings are divided into **personal settings** (accessible to any user for their own account) and **administrative settings** (accessible only to Administrator-role users).

9.1 Personal Settings

- Profile information (name, photo, time zone, language)
- Notification preferences
- Connected personal integrations (e.g., personal calendar sync)
- Two-factor authentication enrollment
- Theme (light/dark mode)

9.2 Administrative Settings

- Organization profile and branding
 - User and role management
 - Security policies (MFA enforcement, session timeout, IP allowlisting)
 - Billing and subscription management
 - Integration and API configuration
 - Data retention and audit log settings
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10. Collaboration Tools

Collaboration features are woven throughout the suite rather than confined only to NovaTech Connect:

- **Comments and @Mentions** are available on CRM records, Project tasks, and Helpdesk tickets, notifying mentioned users regardless of their assigned role on the record.
- **Shared Dashboards** in Insights allow teams to collaborate around the same live data view rather than static exported reports.
- **Co-editing** of shared documents attached within Connect allows multiple users to edit simultaneously with visible cursors and edit history.
- **Cross-Product Linking** allows a CRM deal to be linked directly to a Projects implementation plan, or a Helpdesk ticket to be linked to a related CRM account, creating a unified activity trail visible from either record.

Note: Cross-product linking requires that both linked products be licensed under the same organization account.

11. Intelligent Features and Automation

NovaTech Insights includes a set of intelligent analytics capabilities designed to reduce manual analysis work:

- **Predictive Forecasting** projects likely sales outcomes, project delivery risk, and support ticket volume trends based on historical patterns, available at increasing depth from Professional (sales forecasting only) to Enterprise (full model suite).
- **Anomaly Detection** automatically flags unusual shifts in key metrics — such as a sudden drop in win rate or a spike in ticket volume — surfacing them on the relevant dashboard without requiring a manually configured alert.
- **Natural Language Query** allows users to type a plain-language question and receive a generated chart or table in response, available in English, Spanish, French, German, and Portuguese on Professional and Enterprise editions.

Beyond Insights, automation capabilities exist across the suite:

- CRM Workflow Automation triggers actions based on record changes.
- Helpdesk Automation Rules handle ticket auto-assignment, tagging, and canned response suggestions.
- Connect Workflow Bots handle reminders, polls, and simple approval routing.

Tip: Start with a small number of well-tested automations rather than automating every possible workflow at once; overlapping automations can occasionally produce conflicting actions on the same record, which are logged under Settings > Automation > Conflict Log for review.

12. Exporting Data

Data can be exported from any product in CSV or Excel format, either on demand from a list/report view or on a recurring schedule.

Exporting a Report:

1. Open the desired report.
2. Select Export, then choose CSV or Excel format.
3. For scheduled exports, configure a recurring cadence and delivery method (email or connected cloud storage folder).

Bulk data exports (full object exports rather than a filtered report) are available to Administrator-role users from Data Management > Export, and are logged in the Audit Log for security tracking purposes given the sensitivity of full data exports.

Warning: Scheduled exports containing sensitive customer data should be reviewed periodically to confirm the recipient list remains current, particularly after employee offboarding.

13. Administration

Administrators are responsible for the ongoing configuration and governance of the organization's NovaTech account. Core administrative responsibilities include:

Area	Responsibility
User Lifecycle	Inviting, deactivating, and reassigning licenses for users
Security Configuration	Enforcing MFA, session policies, and IP allowlisting
Data Governance	Setting retention policies, reviewing audit logs, managing export access
Integration Management	Approving and monitoring connected third-party applications
Billing Oversight	Managing subscription tier, seat count, and payment methods

Enterprise administrators additionally manage SSO/SCIM provisioning, custom SLA configuration, and (where applicable) Multi-Org Hierarchy settings for organizations with multiple sub-accounts.

Note: NovaTech recommends a quarterly administrative review of active users, assigned roles, and connected integrations to ensure the account configuration remains aligned with current organizational needs.

14. Best Practices

- Complete the full Organization Setup Checklist (Section 3.1) before inviting the broader user base, to avoid re-training users on settings changed after adoption.
 - Use templates for recurring project types in NovaTech Projects to standardize delivery and reduce setup time.
 - Establish a small number of clearly named custom fields in CRM before large-scale data migration, rather than allowing ad hoc field creation across the team.
 - Configure Daily Digest notifications for users on multiple products to reduce alert fatigue while preserving visibility into important updates.
 - Review Automation Conflict Logs periodically as new automations are added, to catch unintended interactions early.
 - Use scheduled reports and shared dashboards rather than manual data exports where possible, to keep stakeholders working from a single live source of truth.
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15. Summary

This manual covers the full lifecycle of using the NovaTech Solutions suite, from installation and initial setup through daily use of core features, collaboration tools, reporting, and administrative governance. Each of the five products shares a consistent role-based permission model and a common notification and reporting framework, while offering product-specific workflows suited to CRM, project delivery, team collaboration, analytics, and customer support. For deeper detail on any individual topic, refer to the Product Catalog (Document 1) for feature-by-edition availability, the Troubleshooting Guide (Document 4) for issue resolution, and the Account Management Guide (Document 9) for account- and security-specific procedures.

End of Document 5 — Product User Manual. NovaTech Solutions Confidential Documentation.